

Neuromarketing

Complete Exam Study Guide — All Six Lectures

A plain-English walkthrough of the full course: core definitions, key theories, the studies the exam relies on, the distinctions that trip students up, and practice MCQs with answers. Built for a multiple-choice exam.

Course: Neuromarketing & Consumer Psychology · **Format covered:** Multiple-choice questions

Lectures: (1) Introduction (2) Motivation & Involvement (3) Perception (4) Memory & Learning (5) Attitudes (6) Persuasion

Key sources referenced: McClure et al. (2004); Petty & Cacioppo (1986, ELM); Miller (1956); Peterson & Peterson (1959); Pavlov; Skinner; LaPiere (1934); Ajzen (1991, TPB); Heider (Balance Theory); Sherif & Hovland (Social Judgment Theory); North, Hargreaves & McKendrick (1997); Solomon, *Consumer Behavior*.

How to use this guide: Read each lecture's explanation, then memorise the **Key Terms** and **Exam Tips**. The red **"Exam Trap"** boxes are the highest-value items — they mark the exact confusions MCQs are designed to catch. Test yourself with the practice questions at the end of each lecture (answers included).

Lecture 1 — Introduction to Neuromarketing & the Consumer Decision Process

What neuromarketing is

Neuromarketing = Neuroscience + Marketing. It uses brain-imaging and biometric tools to understand the consumer's **unconscious, emotional** drivers — the things traditional research (surveys, focus groups) misses because people can't or won't report them.

Field	Looks at	Type of response
Neuroscience	Unconscious mind	Emotions, feelings, intuition
Traditional marketing	Conscious mind	Facts, reason, logic

Memory hook: "Neuro = the part you can't say out loud; Marketing = the part you can."

Why it matters — New Coke (1985)

Coca-Cola reformulated to a sweeter "New Coke" because **blind taste tests** favoured the sweeter taste. It failed badly and the original returned within ~3 months. **Lesson:** drinking Coke is an emotional experience of memory, identity and nostalgia — traditional research only tested *taste* and ignored the brand's emotional equity.

The brain study: McClure et al. (2004)

Published as "Neural Correlates of Behavioral Preference for Culturally Familiar Drinks," *Neuron*. (The lecturer labels it the "Pepsi Challenge," but that name was originally a 1970s–80s marketing campaign — the science is the 2004 fMRI study.)

- **Blind / anonymous tasting:** preference tracked the **ventromedial prefrontal cortex (vmPFC)**, a reward region. Taste alone; Pepsi often did well.
- **Brand-cued (you see it's Coke):** knowing the brand **shifted preference toward Coke** and activated **memory/culture regions (hippocampus + dorsolateral prefrontal cortex)**.

Takeaway: Taste lives in a reward area; **brand lives in memory/emotion areas, and brand can override taste**. That is exactly why New Coke failed.

Neuromarketing toolkit (match the tool)

What it captures	Tool
Where the eyes look (fixations, heat-maps)	Eye-tracking
Facial expression / emotional reaction (also skin conductance, heart rate)	Emotional Response Analysis (ERA) / GSR
Electrical brain-wave activity	EEG (e.g., Emotiv)
Brain blood-flow map (which regions are active)	fMRI / PET

The Consumer Decision Process (5 stages)

Classic Engel–Kollat–Blackwell model; standard in Solomon's *Consumer Behavior*. Lecture 1 focuses on stages 1–3.

1. Problem recognition → 2. Information search → 3. Evaluation of alternatives → 4. Purchase → 5. Post-purchase evaluation.

Hook: "Please Inform Every Purchasing Person."

Stage 1 — Problem recognition

Occurs when there is a **gap between your current state and your desired (ideal) state**.

Type	What moves	Example
Opportunity recognition	The ideal state rises (you want better)	An ad makes you crave a new car though your current one is fine
Need recognition	The actual state drops (something runs out/breaks)	You run out of petrol; your phone breaks

Stage 2 — Information search

We search to **reduce perceived risk**. Four risk types: **financial, psychological, social, time**. Search increases when the purchase is important/expensive and information is easy to get; it depends on prior knowledge (middle-knowledge people search most). We stop searching when the **cost of more searching exceeds its added value**.

Stage 3 — Evaluation of alternatives & product categorization

Evoked set = all comparable products already in your **memory** for that category. **Consideration set** = the smaller subset you are **actually considering** now. The consideration set sits **inside** the evoked set.

A brand that isn't in the evoked set basically can't be chosen. Consumers understand new products by **comparing them to existing categories**, and how a product is **categorised defines its competitors and the criteria it's judged on**. **Positioning** = convincing consumers a product belongs in a chosen category (e.g., repositioning orange juice as an all-day drink, not just breakfast).

Key terms:

- **Neuromarketing** — measuring unconscious/emotional consumer responses.
- **vmPFC** — reward region active in blind taste preference (McClure).
- **Opportunity vs need recognition** — ideal state ↑ vs actual state ↓.
- **Evoked set** $\supset$ **Consideration set**.
- **Positioning** — grouping that defines competitors and choice criteria.

Exam tips: The neuroscience-vs-marketing (unconscious vs conscious) split is the most likely definition question. For "which type of problem recognition?" — check whether the **ideal** or the **actual** state changed. Don't swap evoked (in memory) and consideration (actively weighed) — consideration is the smaller, inner one.

Practice (answers in blue):

1. A car still runs fine, but a sleek new model's ad makes the owner crave an upgrade. → **Opportunity recognition** (ideal state rises).
2. In McClure (2004), which condition activated memory/cultural brain regions and shifted preference to Coke? → **Brand-cued condition**.
3. True/False: The consideration set is larger than the evoked set. → **False** (it is smaller; it sits inside the evoked set).
4. Which technique measures where the eyes fixate? → **Eye-tracking**.
5. Why did New Coke fail despite winning blind taste tests? → **It won on taste alone, but Coke's value lived in emotional brand memory (nostalgia, identity). Brand memory overrides taste in the brain (McClure 2004), so a "better-tasting" product still failed.**

Lecture 2 — Motivation & Involvement

Motivation

Motivation = an activated inner state of tension that drives a person toward a goal (a desired end-state). Three parts: it is **inner**, it is **tension**, and it is **goal-directed**.

The chain: a **need** is recognised (**need = the gap between an actual and a desired state**) → the gap creates **tension** = motivation → tension drives behaviour to close the gap. Marketing positions a product as the thing that closes the gap.

Exam trap: a **need is the gap, never the product**. The product is only the means to close it.

Consumer goals: approach vs avoidance

Motivation	You are...	Example
Approach	moving toward a positive outcome	Buying ice cream because it's delicious
Avoidance	moving away from a negative outcome	Buying deodorant to avoid body odour

Three motivational conflicts (Lewin)

Conflict	Structure	Key point
Approach–Approach	Two desirable options (car vs world trip)	Breeds cognitive dissonance (Festinger): post-decision regret over what you gave up. Reduce it by favouring the chosen option.
Approach–Avoidance	One option, both positive and negative (tasty but fattening cake)	Marketer's fix: remove the negative — "use Y to avoid X" (low-calorie cake).
Avoidance–Avoidance	Two undesirable options (repair old car vs buy new — both hurt)	Reframe one as less painful (financing/payment plans).

Hook: A-A = two goods (dissonance risk); A-Av = one thing, mixed feelings; Av-Av = two bads.

Involvement

Consumer involvement = the perceived personal relevance/interest a person attaches to a product. It varies by product category (houses = high, salt = low) and by person (**Need for Cognition** = the trait of enjoying effortful thinking).

	Low-involvement consumer	High-involvement consumer
Message	Short, repeated, visual	Detailed; pros and cons
What moves them	Price , in-store displays, wide distribution	Argument quality, product information

The top of the involvement scale brings brand loyalty → **flow state** (total absorption) → **cult product** (fierce devotion, e.g., Harley-Davidson).

The Elaboration Likelihood Model — Petty & Cacioppo (1986)

The single most important model in this lecture. Two routes to attitude change.

	Central route	Peripheral route
Triggered by	High involvement	Low involvement
What persuades	Argument quality — logic, facts	Peripheral cues — attractiveness, celebrity, music, colour
Resulting attitude	Strong, lasting, resistant	Weaker, temporary

Exam trap (durability): central-route change is **more lasting** because the person reasoned it themselves; peripheral-route change is **temporary**. MCQs love asking which one lasts.

Rahimi et al. (2019): a study of attitudes toward a website classed informativeness/credibility/economic value as **central** cues and entertainment/interactivity/materialism as **peripheral** cues — and found **both** influenced attitude. Good web ads can work through both routes.

Key terms:

- **Motivation** — inner tension toward a desired end-state. **Need** = actual-vs-desired gap.
- **Approach vs avoidance** — toward good vs away from bad.
- **Three conflicts** — approach-approach, approach-avoidance, avoidance-avoidance.
- **Cognitive dissonance** — post-decision tension (Festinger); specific to approach-approach.
- **Need for cognition** — trait: enjoyment of effortful thinking.
- **ELM** — central (argument) vs peripheral (cues) route.

Exam tips: Match ELM routes by the cue — facts/specs → central/high involvement; celebrity/attractiveness/music/colour → peripheral/low involvement. "Use Y to avoid X" is always **approach-avoidance**. Cognitive dissonance is a **post-purchase / approach-approach** phenomenon.

Practice:

1. Two attractive holidays, can afford one; after booking, unease about the rejected one. → **Approach–approach with cognitive dissonance.**
2. A high-involvement consumer is most persuaded by → **strong, high-quality arguments (central route).**
3. Most durable attitude change comes from the → **central route.**
4. Best tactic to win low-involvement tissue shoppers → **price promotions + prominent shelf displays.**
5. "Use Listerine to avoid bad breath" resolves which conflict? → **Approach–avoidance.**

Lecture 3 — Perception

Perception = the process by which sensations are selected, organised and interpreted. A **sensation** is the raw input; **perception** is the meaning we build on top of it.

The three stages of perception (master framework)

Stage	Definition	Handle
1. Exposure	A stimulus comes within range of a sensory receptor	"It reaches you"
2. Attention	Mental resources are devoted to a stimulus	"You notice it"
3. Interpretation	Meaning is assigned to an attended stimulus	"You make sense of it"

Hook: E-A-I = "Each Add Informs."

Sensory marketing

- **Sight:** colour drives emotion — red = arousal/appetite, blue = calm; saturated colours grab attention but cause visual fatigue. **Trade dress** = colours/visual style so tied to a brand they identify it (Coca-Cola red, Tiffany blue).
- **Smell:** odours stir emotion and create calm (ambient scent marketing).
- **Sound — North, Hargreaves & McKendrick (1997):** in a shop, French music days → French wine outsold German; German music days → the reverse. Music is a **peripheral cue steering choice without shoppers realising**.

Exposure & sensory thresholds

Threshold	Definition
Absolute threshold	Minimum intensity needed to detect a stimulus at all
Differential threshold	Ability to detect a difference between two stimuli; the smallest detectable change = JND (Just Noticeable Difference)

Marketers shrink a product or raise price **just below the JND** so nobody notices.

Subliminal perception (myth-buster)

Subliminal perception = a stimulus presented **below the absolute threshold** (below conscious awareness).

Exam trap — James Vicary (1957): his flashed "Eat popcorn / Drink Coke" cinema study was **never replicated and was admitted to be a hoax**. If an option calls it proof that subliminal ads work, it's wrong.

Holland et al. (2005): a hidden citrus cleaning scent made people clean up crumbs more, without awareness — evidence that **subtle** cues *can* nudge behaviour. Overall verdict: little evidence for classic subliminal advertising; subtle cues have modest effects.

Attention

Because of **perceptual selection**, we attend to only a fraction of what reaches us. Attention is captured by **size, colour, and position**; people scan from the centre then left→right, so place key items centre/upper-left and at eye level.

Interpretation & Gestalt principles

Gestalt principles describe how we perceive objects as meaningful **wholes**: "the whole is different from the sum of its parts."

Principle	Meaning	Marketing use
Similarity (→ Anomaly)	Similar elements group as one; a dissimilar one stands out (anomaly)	Make the key item different so it pops
Closure	We mentally complete an incomplete image	Logos with gaps (brain finishes them)
Figure–ground	One part dominates (figure), the rest recedes (ground)	Control foreground; hidden second images

Key terms:

- **Three stages** — Exposure → Attention → Interpretation.
- **Trade dress** — brand-defining colours/style.
- **Absolute threshold** (detect presence) vs **differential threshold / JND** (detect a difference).
- **Subliminal perception** — below the absolute threshold; Vicary = hoax.
- **Gestalt** — similarity (+anomaly), closure, figure–ground.

Exam tips: Stage-matching is the #1 question: reaches senses = exposure; noticing = attention; meaning = interpretation. Absolute = detect presence; JND = detect a difference. Gestalt by signature: gap→closure, standout→anomaly, foreground/hidden→figure-ground.

Practice:

1. Eyes register a billboard but the mind never processes it — reached which stage, failed which? → **Reached exposure, failed attention.**
2. Shrinking a bar so no one notices relies on keeping the change below the → **differential threshold (JND).**
3. Vicary's 1957 study → **was admitted to be a hoax and never replicated.**
4. One bright red figure among identical grey ones draws the eye → **Anomaly (within similarity).**
5. A logo with missing lines still reads as a panda → **Closure.**

Lecture 4 — Memory & Learning

Memory systems

Memory = encoding → storage → retrieval. Information flows: Sensory → (attention) → Short-Term → (elaborative rehearsal) → Long-Term.

System	Duration	Capacity
Sensory memory	1–few seconds	Very large; lost if not attended
Short-term (STM)	~ 18 seconds (Peterson, 1959)	5–9 units (Miller, 1956 — "7±2"); expanded by chunking
Long-term (LTM)	Permanent	Unlimited

Two gatekeepers: **attention** moves info sensory → STM; **elaborative rehearsal** moves info STM → LTM.

Associative network & spreading activation

Associative network = LTM stored as a web of linked **nodes** (concepts). **Spreading activation** = activating one node spreads to connected ones. Brands build associations so one cue (jingle, colour, celebrity) pulls the whole brand network into mind.

Boosting storage vs retrieval

Storage method	Meaning
Chunking	Group items into units
Rehearsal	Active reviewing (jingles you repeat)
Recirculation	Remembered via passive repetition (seeing an ad repeatedly)
Elaboration	Messages that make you think → moved to LTM

Retrieval boosters: pioneering brand (first in market recalled more); descriptive names ("Reduce Fat Fast"); **state-dependent retrieval** (mood at recall matches mood at encoding); **von Restorff effect** (unusual items recalled better); visual and emotional messages recalled better.

Exam trap: **rehearsal = active** effort; **recirculation = passive** repetition. Both use repetition, only rehearsal is deliberate.

Classical conditioning (Pavlov)

Classical conditioning = learning an association between two stimuli.

Term	Definition	In a "beautiful woman + product" ad
UCS (unconditioned stimulus)	Naturally triggers a response	Beautiful woman
UCR (unconditioned response)	Automatic response to UCS	Arousal
CS (conditioned stimulus)	Neutral thing paired with UCS	The product
CR (conditioned response)	Learned response to the CS alone	Arousal, now from the product

- **Extinction:** the CR fades when the CS appears repeatedly **without** the UCS. (The link dies from neglect.)
- **Stimulus generalization:** a **similar** stimulus evokes the same response → lookalike packaging. (The link spreads to cousins.)
- **Stimulus discrimination:** responding only to the exact original CS (the opposite of generalization).

Operant conditioning (Skinner) — the biggest exam trap in the course

Operant conditioning = learning an association between behaviour and its consequences.

Type	Mechanism	Effect	Example
Positive reinforcement	Add something pleasant	Behaviour ↑	Loyalty stamps
Negative reinforcement	Remove/avoid something unpleasant	Behaviour ↑	Take a painkiller, headache goes away → repeat
Punishment	Add something unpleasant	Behaviour ↓	Ridiculed for a bad choice

THE #1 trap: negative reinforcement is NOT punishment. "Negative" means **removing** a stimulus, not "bad." Both reinforcements (positive AND negative) **increase** behaviour. Only **punishment decreases** it.
Operant extinction = a behaviour fades when the reinforcement (reward) stops.

Link to involvement: **low-involvement** consumers learn mainly through behavioural conditioning (repetition, rewards); **high-involvement** consumers lean on cognitive learning.

Key terms:

- **Memory systems** — sensory / STM (~18s, 7±2) / LTM (permanent).
- **Gatekeepers** — attention (sensory→STM), elaborative rehearsal (STM→LTM).
- **Associative network / spreading activation / nodes.**
- **Rehearsal (active) vs recirculation (passive).**
- **UCS, UCR, CS, CR; extinction, generalization, discrimination.**
- **Positive / negative reinforcement, punishment, extinction.**

Exam tips: If behaviour **increased** by **removing/avoiding** something → negative reinforcement, never punishment. STM ≈ 18s, 5–9 units. Similar stimulus triggers response = generalization; only exact CS works = discrimination. Extinction = response fades when pairing/reward stops.

Practice:

1. "Sign up so you never face a huge unexpected bill again" — sign-ups rise by removing a dreaded outcome. → **Negative reinforcement.**
2. Correct memory flow → **Sensory →(attention)→ STM →(elaborative rehearsal)→ LTM.**
3. Own-brand cola copies Coca-Cola's red can to transfer good feelings. → **Stimulus generalization.**
4. Miller (1956) STM capacity → **5–9 units.**
5. In a celebrity perfume ad, the new fragrance is the → **CS (conditioned stimulus).**
6. A jingle's learned response fades after the campaign stops. → **Extinction.**

Lecture 5 — Attitudes

Attitude = a disposition to evaluate an attitude object with some degree of favour or disfavour (always positive or negative). The **multicomponent (ABC) model**: we evaluate through **cognition** (thoughts), **affect** (feelings), and **behaviour** — think / feel / do.

Two properties

- **Valence** = direction (positive or negative).
- **Strength** = intensity/importance. **Strong attitudes** are tied to values and self-concept, held with certainty, spring to mind easily, guide behaviour, and persist over time.

Ambivalence

Ambivalence = being conflicted — holding both advantages and disadvantages toward the same object (an unresolved, unpleasant feeling).

Ambivalent ≠ indifferent (ambivalent = strong feelings both ways; indifferent = no feelings). Twist: research found ambivalent attitudes can still **guide behaviour**, because the conflicting information triggers deeper processing → stronger attitudes (ELM link).

Explicit vs implicit attitudes

	Explicit	Implicit
Awareness	Conscious & controlled	Unconscious & automatic
Measured by	Questionnaires, interviews	Reaction-time tasks (IAT)
Weakness	People can distort answers	Hard to fake

Self-report biases: social desirability (answering to look good), **demand characteristics** (guessing the study's aim), **Hawthorne effect** (changing behaviour because you know you're observed). **IAT rule: faster reaction time = stronger association**. If implicit and explicit match → strong attitude; if they conflict → weak/ambivalent.

Dual attitudes vs ambivalence (key distinction)

Dual attitudes = an explicit and an implicit attitude existing side-by-side, possibly different. Implicit is often the stronger, automatic default and goes unnoticed. **Which one wins depends on cognitive capacity/motivation** — with plenty of resources the explicit can override the implicit; when tired/rushed the implicit wins.

Exam trap: Ambivalence = a state of conflict ("I feel two ways"). **Dual attitudes = which attitude is most accessible** ("I have two attitudes — conscious + automatic — and context picks one"). If the person *feels torn* → ambivalence. If there's a stated attitude plus a hidden automatic one → dual.

Attitudes & behaviour

LaPiere (1934): travelled the USA with a young Chinese couple; served at 250+ venues (refused only once), yet almost all of those venues later said by questionnaire they would **not** serve Chinese guests. → **Attitudes don't always predict behaviour.**

Theory of Planned Behaviour — Ajzen (1991): behaviour follows from **intention**, shaped by three inputs:

Factor	Meaning
Attitude	Your own evaluation of the behaviour
Subjective norms	Belief that important people approve/disapprove
Perceived control	How much control you feel you have

Attitude + Norms + Control → Intention → Behaviour. Direction: **strong** attitude → attitude drives behaviour ("I like it, so I buy it"); **weak** attitude → attitude is inferred from behaviour ("I bought it, so I must like it" — self-perception).

Key terms:

- **Attitude** — evaluation (favour/disfavour); ABC model (think/feel/do).
- **Valence** (direction) vs **strength** (intensity).
- **Ambivalence** — conflicted; not indifferent.
- **Explicit vs implicit; IAT** (faster = stronger association).
- **Social desirability / demand characteristics / Hawthorne effect.**
- **Dual attitudes** — coexisting, accessibility decides.
- **LaPiere (1934); TPB (Ajzen 1991).**

Exam tips: Feel torn = ambivalence; two attitudes, accessibility = dual. IAT: faster = stronger (don't invert). Hawthorne = behaviour changes because of being observed. TPB has **three** intention inputs. Strong attitude → attitude first; weak → behaviour first.

Practice:

1. Sincere pro-elderly survey answer + automatic negative bias that surfaces when rushed. → **Dual attitudes.**
2. "Elderly + unpleasant" paired faster than "elderly + pleasant" in an IAT → **stronger negative implicit association.**
3. LaPiere (1934) shows → **attitudes do not always predict behaviour.**
4. TPB: intention = attitude + perceived control + → **subjective norms.**
5. "I keep buying it, so I guess I like it." → **Behaviour driving attitude (weak attitude inferred).**
6. Genuinely torn about fast fashion — loves the price, hates the impact, conflict unresolved. → **Ambivalence.**

Lecture 6 — Persuasion

Balance Theory (Heider)

An attitude structure is a triad: (1) the person/observer, (2) an attitude object, (3) another person linked to that object. Each of the three relationships is positive (+) or negative (-). Relations should be **balanced**; if not, **tension** pushes the person to change an attitude.

How to check balance: multiply the three signs (or count the minus signs). **Even number of minuses (0 or 2) = balanced** (comfortable). **Odd number (1 or 3) = unbalanced** (tension).

Marketing use: pair a **liked celebrity** with a **neutral new brand**; positive affect **spills over** onto the brand, so the consumer resolves tension by liking it. **Risk:** it backfires if the link looks fake or breaks (e.g., an endorser seen using a rival brand). Fix: use credible/expert endorsers who use the product publicly. Three ways to restore balance in an unbalanced triad: change the attitude to the celebrity, change the attitude to the brand (the goal), or decide the celebrity doesn't really like the brand.

Social Judgment Theory (Sherif & Hovland)

A persuasive message's effect depends on how far its position sits from the receiver's own attitude. Each person has three zones (latitudes) around their attitude.

Latitude	Effect	Attitude change?
Acceptance (close to your view)	Assimilation — seen as more similar than it is	No change
Rejection (far from your view)	Contrast — seen as more extreme/threatening than it is	No change
Non-commitment (in-between)	Neither assimilation nor contrast	Change happens here

Exam trap: change happens **only in the latitude of non-commitment**. Too close (acceptance) = you already agree, no change. Too far (rejection) = the contrast effect makes you dig in. You can move someone one step, not ten.

Siero & Doosje (1993): tested SJT with car/environment messages — messages in the non-commitment zone produced the most attitude change. Practical lesson: do market research to find that zone.

Appeals

Appeal	Strength	Catch / when it works
Sexual	Grabs attention, boosts ad memory & purchase intention	Men recall less brand info ; effects short-term; only helps if the product relates to sex; suits low-involvement
Humorous	Attracts attention, lifts mood, stops counter-arguing	Reduces comprehension; wears out fast; needs to fit the brand and not bury the message
Fear	Highlights negative consequences of not changing	Works only if the threat is moderate AND a solution is offered

Why fear appeals fail: reactance (people defend their personal freedom and rebel) or **denial** (they dismiss threatening information). Fear appeals are common in social marketing.

Persuasive paradigms & the Fishbein Model

Named in the course objectives but not developed in the slide deck — included here from standard literature for completeness.

- **Implementation intentions:** concrete "if-then" plans linking a situation to an action ("If it's Monday morning, then I'll go to the gym"). They bridge the intention-behaviour gap and raise follow-through.
- **Anticipated regret:** prompting people to imagine how much they'll regret *not* acting nudges them to act (used in vaccination, insurance, limited-time offers).
- **Fishbein (multi-attribute) model:** overall attitude = the sum of beliefs about each attribute × how much you value each attribute. (One-line idea only; not detailed in the slides.)

Key terms:

- **Balance Theory** — triad; even minuses = balanced; affect spills from celebrity to brand.
- **Social Judgment Theory** — latitudes of acceptance / rejection / non-commitment; assimilation vs contrast; change in non-commitment.
- **Appeals** — sexual, humorous, fear (each with its catch).
- **Reactance & denial** — why fear appeals fail.
- (From literature) **Implementation intentions, anticipated regret, Fishbein.**

Exam tips: Balance — count the minuses (even = balanced). SJT — assimilation = seen closer (acceptance, no change); contrast = seen more extreme (rejection, no change); change only in non-commitment. Fear needs moderate threat + a solution, and fails via reactance/denial. Sexual appeal: men recall less brand info, short-term.

Practice:

1. Consumer dislikes a celebrity (-), likes a brand (+), celebrity endorses brand (+). → **Unbalanced (one minus = odd).**
2. A message in the zone where you neither embrace nor reject it is the latitude of ___ and produces ___. → **Non-commitment; attitude change.**
3. Overwhelming gore with no way to act fails because of → **reactance or denial.**
4. A message close to your view, seen as even more similar, no change → **Assimilation effect.**
5. A downside of sexual appeals (per the slides) → **men recall less brand info; effects are short-term.**
6. Pairing a liked celebrity with a neutral brand works because → **positive affect spills over onto the brand.**

Quick "Exam Trap" Sheet — the distinctions MCQs target

Confusable pair	How to tell them apart
Need vs opportunity recognition	Actual state drops = need ; ideal state rises = opportunity .
Evoked vs consideration set	Evoked = everything in memory; consideration = the smaller subset actively weighed (sits inside evoked).
Central vs peripheral route (ELM)	Argument/logic = central (lasts); cues like celebrity/music = peripheral (fades).
The three conflicts	Two goods = approach-approach; one mixed = approach-avoidance ("use Y to avoid X"); two bads = avoidance-avoidance.
Absolute vs differential threshold	Detect presence = absolute; detect a difference = differential (JND).
Negative reinforcement vs punishment	Remove a bad thing → behaviour ↑ = negative reinforcement. Add a bad thing → behaviour ↓ = punishment.
Extinction vs generalization	Response fades when reward/pairing stops = extinction. Similar stimulus triggers the response = generalization.
Rehearsal vs recirculation	Active review = rehearsal; passive repetition = recirculation.
Ambivalence vs dual attitudes	Feel torn/conflicted = ambivalence. Stated attitude + hidden automatic one, accessibility decides = dual.
Explicit vs implicit attitude	Conscious self-report = explicit; automatic, reaction-time/IAT = implicit (faster = stronger).
Assimilation vs contrast (SJT)	Seen as closer than it is (acceptance zone) = assimilation; seen as more extreme (rejection zone) = contrast. Neither produces change — only non-commitment does.
Balance: balanced vs unbalanced	Even number of minus signs = balanced (no tension); odd = unbalanced (tension).

A note on accuracy. Definitions and study findings here follow the lecture slides and standard consumer-behaviour sources (Solomon, *Consumer Behavior*; the cited primary studies). Two items — implementation intentions and anticipated regret — appear in the course objectives but were not developed in the slides, so their explanations are drawn from established psychology literature and labelled as such. The Fishbein model is listed but not detailed in the slides. For anything weighted heavily on your specific exam, cross-check with your lecturer's own notes.